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CONTEMPORARY INDIA ANCHOR — CONSTITUTIONAL MORALITY AND RELIGIOUS PRACTICE [SUPPORTING]

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Contemporary India anchor — constitutional morality and religious practice [SUPPORTING]: □ Fact: Reporting on the 2026 Sabarimala review hearings describes the Supreme Court's renewed examination of equality, religious freedom, essential religious practices and constitutional morality.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□□ Inference: The controversy illustrates the owner's interaction thesis: morality may be shaped by religion, while public moral principles may also criticise religious practices.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

It does not by itself settle the philosophical question whether morality is grounded in religion.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

It does not by itself settle the philosophical question whether morality is grounded in religion.

ANSWER LINE: □ Fact: Reporting on the 2026 Sabarimala review hearings describes the Supreme Court's renewed examination of equality, religious freedom, essential religious practices and constitutional morality.

02

VISUAL GATEWAY — IDENTIFY THE RELATION BEFORE ARGUING

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Visual gateway — identify the relation before arguing: Master verdict: Morality is not conceptually reducible to religion, but religion can supply motivation, formation and cosmic significance; morality in turn remains an indispensable internal and external critic of religious life.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The dependence view holds that morality requires religion for its authority, motivation or ultimate sanction, but these three claims must be assessed separately.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Master verdict: Morality is not conceptually reducible to religion, but religion can supply motivation, formation and cosmic significance; morality in turn remains an indispensable internal and external critic of religious life.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Master verdict: Morality is not conceptually reducible to religion, but religion can supply motivation, formation and cosmic significance; morality in turn remains an indispensable internal and external critic of religious life.

ANSWER LINE: Moral obligation can be grounded independently in reason, welfare, virtue, human dignity or the reduction of suffering, even when religion strengthens motivation.